

Working with files. Feed in your 2D outlines using AutoCAD DXF files. Design parameters included in these files can also be understood by the tool. You can even choose to work with STL and OFF files, also creating 3D models in the respective formats.

Securing the help you need.

OpenSCAD also enjoys an active community support that you can reach out to. Simply navigate to Community tab on their website and you can find all details about the issues faced by users so far. You could report a new bug, or provide a solution to one already enlisted.

The website also provides ample help to a new designer. There is a cheat sheet to help you create designs as simple as a function or a circle, to projections or transformations. Tips and Tricks and FAQ sections discuss most problems you might be facing.

Many blogs by users explain

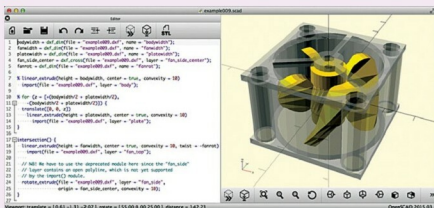


Fig. 3: OpenSCAD user interface

how to use the tool, get familiar with advanced features and how to make simple projects. Bored to read? Log on to video tutorials—all from Documentation page.

Igniting the spark of inspiration

OpenSCAD works as a good entry-level CAD tool for designing open source hardware, such as scientific

tools for research and education. The tool has also inspired or been involved with many others such as OpenJSCAD, CoffeeSCAD, Libre 3D and FABFabbers, to name a few. Now that you have the package with your DVD, why not try it for yourself? **EFY**

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